



Rayven Crisafulli, PhD, CMP

EVENT DESIGN EDUCATOR · FOUNDER, RESONANCE CO.

resonanceco.co

hello@resonanceco.co

Sessions on the *craft* of event design: grounded in doctoral research, shaped by thirteen years of planning, customized to your audience.

FEATURED SESSIONS

Designing for Resonance

Any planner can add a creative touch. Resonance Mapping, the framework from Rayven's doctoral research, uses identity, experience, and narrative to map details so they carry meaning for a specific audience, applied live to attendees' own events.

The Science Behind the Event Experience

The industry talks constantly about "experience" and rarely defines it. The research on what attendees genuinely feel, in plain planner language, with a clear way to evaluate whether a program delivers.

Grounded by Design

"Elevated" has been the industry's favorite brief for a decade, and elevation often works against resonance: spectacle is rarely what guests carry home. The case for designing from identity instead of trend.

Keynote, breakout, or half-day workshop · Content customized per program · Full Course Catalog at Resonanceco.co

Learning objectives provided for CE documentation · Materials ahead of your print deadline · Standard AV

Based in North Florida, travels from Jacksonville (JAX)

"She made all topics engaging (even finance and legal elements)." · STUDENT EVALUATION, 2021

Fourteen semesters · University of Florida · Instructor ratings 4.4–4.96 · Documented top-ranked instructor in department

SEEN ON: NEWS4JAX · FOX 35 ORLANDO · NBC 6 SOUTH FLORIDA · WUFT-FM (NPR)

CREDENTIALS

PhD, Tourism, Hospitality & Event Management UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA	CMP · CMP-HC CERTIFIED MEETING PROFESSIONAL · HEALTHCARE
Author, <i>Event Planning & Management</i> KENDALL HUNT · 2ND EDITION	Thirteen years in the industry CONFERENCES · WEDDINGS · CLASSROOMS



START A CONVERSATION: [HELLO@RESONANCECO.CO](mailto:hello@resonanceco.co)

Full details, video, and session catalog: resonanceco.co/speak.html



BIO · 25 WORDS

Rayven Crisafulli, PhD, CMP, planned conferences and weddings for thirteen years, earned a doctorate studying what brings people back to events, and founded Resonance Co. to teach the answer.

BIO · 50 WORDS

Rayven Crisafulli, PhD, CMP, spent seven years planning medical education conferences and seven running her own wedding company before returning to school to study what brings people back to events. She now teaches event design through Resonance Co. Her textbook, *Event Planning & Management* (Kendall Hunt), is in its second edition.

BIO · 100 WORDS

Rayven Crisafulli, PhD, CMP, is the founder of Resonance Co., an event design education company for planners who treat the work as craft. She spent seven years planning medical education conferences and seven running her own wedding company, and the same question followed her through both: why do some events energize their audiences while others fall flat? Her doctorate went looking for the answer, a dissertation on event brands tested with 400 festival-goers at EDC to trace what brings people back. The framework it produced, Resonance Mapping, is what Resonance Co. teaches. She has taught fourteen semesters at the University of Florida, one as the department's top-ranked instructor. Her textbook, *Event Planning & Management* (Kendall Hunt), is in its second edition.

EMCEE INTRODUCTION · READ ALOUD, ~30 SECONDS

Our next speaker spent thirteen years planning events, from medical education conferences to six-figure weddings, before going back to school to study what brings people back to events. She has taught event management for fourteen semesters at the University of Florida, wrote a textbook now in its second edition, and founded Resonance Co. to bring that research to rooms like this one. Please welcome Dr. Rayven Crisafulli.

SESSION DESCRIPTIONS & LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Designing for Resonance

Experienced planners can feel the difference between an event that energizes its audience and one that falls flat; explaining that difference to a client or a committee is harder. This session introduces Resonance Mapping, the three-axis framework from Rayven's doctoral research on event brands (identity, experience architecture, flow state and narrative), and the idea underneath it: resonance, a relationship of call and response, the feeling of being recognized, and recognizing back. Attendees apply it live to their own events and leave with a repeatable system for what they have been doing on instinct, and the language to defend it.

Participants will be able to:

1. Define resonance as a designable, measurable outcome of event experience.
2. Apply Resonance Mapping to an existing event to identify where recognition is designed in and where it is left to chance.
3. Evaluate design decisions by their contribution to attendee experience rather than spectacle.

The Science Behind the Event Experience

Everyone in events talks about "experience"; far fewer can say what actually makes one. This session walks through the research on what attendees genuinely feel in an event (flow, liminality, *communitas*, in plain planner language) and gives the audience a shared vocabulary for what their events are designed to do, and a clear way to evaluate whether they are doing it. No theory background required; first delivered at Catersource + The Special Event in Orlando.

Participants will be able to:

1. Describe how attendees perceive, filter, and retain event experiences.
2. Identify the conditions under which event moments become memorable.
3. Apply experience research to program and agenda design decisions.

Grounded by Design: The Case Against Elevation

"Elevated" has been the industry's favorite brief for a decade, and elevation often works against resonance: when design prioritizes aesthetic sophistication over the identity of the people attending, the result is spectacle, and spectacle is rarely what guests carry home. Attendees leave with a practical vocabulary for redirecting clients and stakeholders from trend-driven briefs toward identity-grounded ones.

Participants will be able to:

1. Distinguish spectacle-driven design from audience-specific design in event briefs.
2. Evaluate proposed design elements against audience identity rather than trend.
3. Use stakeholder-ready language to redirect budgets toward elements attendees will remember.